

DOCUMENT 1

STRATEGIC COMMUNITY, CORPORATE & MEDIA PARTNER OUTREACH PROCESS

Student Impact Challenge (S.I.C.) — Fellow Outreach Assignment

OBJECTIVE

Build a disciplined pipeline of community partners, media partners, corporate sponsors, scholarship partners, and prize/experience partners that can help expand awareness and opportunity for young people participating in the statewide Student Impact Challenge.

The Rule: Do Not Start by Asking Everyone for Money

Different organizations can contribute different forms of value. The fellow's job is to understand the organization first, identify the strongest alignment, make one appropriate initial ask, and move interested prospects to program leadership.

STEP 1 — Select the Prospect

Choose a qualified organization: community nonprofit, bank, financial institution, radio/TV outlet, sports organization, hotel, automotive company/dealership, footwear/apparel brand, gym/fitness company, technology company, airline, retailer, healthcare organization, university, foundation, or major local employer.

STEP 2 — Decide the Partnership Angle

Before contacting anyone, decide what would make sense for that prospect. Banks may fit scholarships and financial literacy; radio may fit awareness; sports organizations may fit tickets and winner experiences; hotels may fit event space or educator experiences; apparel companies may fit student prizes; gyms may fit wellness; technology companies may fit devices and innovation support.

STEP 3 — Find the Correct Department

Avoid generic customer service whenever possible. Search for Community Relations, Community Impact, Corporate Social Responsibility, Corporate Affairs, Foundation, Partnerships, Sponsorships, Marketing, Public Relations, Government Affairs, Youth Programs, Local Market President, or General Manager.

STEP 4 — Identify a Real Decision-Maker

Use the organization's official website, LinkedIn, leadership pages, press releases, foundation pages and local office pages. Record the person's full name, exact title, email/contact route, phone if publicly available, and source.

STEP 5 — Research Their Existing Community Work

Find at least one relevant initiative the organization already supports involving youth, education, entrepreneurship, scholarships, economic mobility, community improvement, workforce development, innovation or local families. Use this research to personalize the outreach.

STEP 6 — Choose ONE Initial Ask

Do not send a menu of demands. Choose the best first ask: awareness partner, community partner, scholarship partner, media partner, prize/experience partner, business-access partner, or corporate sponsor conversation.

STEP 7 — Send a Short Personalized Email

Introduce the Student Impact Challenge, ages 10–20, statewide New York scope, \$100,000+ in scholarships/cash/prizes, registration at FrantzCoutard.com, nonprofit operation by TrendCatch Gives Back Inc., and the specific reason their organization aligns. Mention Daymond John's support in meeting the winners when appropriate.

STEP 8 — Provide One Simple Overview

Use the approved one-page program or partnership overview. Do not overwhelm a first contact with a large presentation unless requested.

STEP 9 — Follow Up in 3–5 Business Days

If there is no response, send a concise follow-up. Restate the alignment and ask whether they are the appropriate contact. If not, politely request a referral to the correct person.

STEP 10 — Use a Second Channel

For high-priority prospects, use LinkedIn or a professional phone call after the initial email. The goal is not to pressure the prospect; it is to make sure the request reaches the appropriate team.

STEP 11 — Escalate Positive Interest

Once a prospect expresses interest, the fellow should not negotiate sponsorship amounts, benefits, exclusivity, or official terms. Notify program leadership and arrange the next conversation.

STEP 12 — Track Every Action

Every prospect must be recorded with organization, category, contact, title, email, phone, research notes, partnership angle, date contacted, follow-up date, response, status and next action.

How to Approach Each Major Category

Category	Who to Find	Best Partnership Angle
Banks & Financial Institutions	Community Impact, Foundation, Corporate Responsibility, local market leadership	Scholarships, financial education, student entrepreneurship, economic empowerment
Radio Stations	Community Affairs, Promotions, Public Affairs, General Manager	PSAs, interviews, registration awareness, student stories
Television & Media	Community Affairs, Assignment/Community Desk, Public Relations	Community-calendar awareness, stories, interviews and winner coverage
Sports Organizations	Community Relations, Team Foundation, Social Responsibility, Partnerships	Tickets, experiences, recognition, youth inspiration and sponsorship
Hotels	General Manager, Sales & Marketing, Community Relations	Event space, educator/winner experiences, hospitality support
Automotive Companies & Dealerships	Corporate community impact plus local dealer leadership	Scholarships, transportation, Future Innovator awards, local activation
Footwear & Apparel	Community Impact, Social Impact, Brand Partnerships, local activation teams	Student prizes, apparel, recognition and sponsorship
Gyms & Fitness Companies	Regional marketing, community relations, franchise/local ownership	Wellness programming, memberships, prizes and local promotion
Technology & Telecom	Community Impact, Education, Social Impact, Corporate Affairs	Devices, connectivity, workshops, innovation prizes and sponsorship
Universities & Colleges	Community engagement, entrepreneurship centers, admissions/outreach, advancement	Scholarships, campus experiences, mentors, judges and student recruitment

Daily Fellow Target

Recommended daily workflow: 5 new corporate/media prospects + 5 new community organizations + 5 follow-ups. Quality matters more than sending large numbers of generic emails. Every new prospect should have a documented reason for alignment.

Before Sending Any Outreach — 7-Point Check

1. Is this organization a legitimate fit?
2. Did I find the correct department/person?
3. Did I research something they already support?
4. Did I select one clear partnership angle?
5. Is the message personalized?
6. Did I verify all program facts before sending?
7. Did I enter the prospect and follow-up date in the tracker?

When to Hand the Lead to Program Leadership

Immediately escalate when a prospect asks for a meeting, sponsorship package, contribution amount, partnership benefits, exclusivity, legal documentation, nonprofit documentation, media interview, event commitment, prize commitment, use of logos, or formal agreement.

Program Contact

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